

..... ECOLE DES BEAUX ARTS.....

ECOLE NATIONALE SUPERIEURE DES BEAUX ARTS. THATS THE OFFICIAL NAME FOR IT THO IT WAS ALWAYS CALLED SIMPLY " ~~THE~~ BEAUX ARTS". THE BUILDINGS OF THE SCHOOL LIE ALONG THE LEFT BANK OF THE SEINE NEAR THE QUAI D'ORSAY.. JUST ACROSS THE RIVER FROM THE FAMOUS LOUVRE MUSEUM.

WHEN WE FIRST WENT TO SEE THE SCHOOL AND TO MEET OUR PROFESSORS WE RODE THE METRO TO ST. GERMAIN DES PRES. ~~THIS IS THE CHURCH OF ST GERMAIN DE PRES, ONE OF THE OLDEST IN PARIS AND IT IS LOCATED ON THE CORNER OF BOULEVARD ST. MICHEL, OR "BULL MICH" AS ALL THE STUDENTS CALLED IT.~~

HARV AND I CAME UP OUT OF THE STATION IN TO THE BRIGHT OCTOBER SUN AND WALKED ACROSS THE PLACE ST GERMAIN ^{PAST THE CHURCH} AND DOWN THE NARROW RUE DE BONAPARTE. THE STREET ~~WAS~~ WAS LINED WITH ART GALLERIES, ARTISTS SUPPLY STORES, AND BOOK SHOPS. PEOPLE WERE CROWDED IN THE STREETS, OVERFLOWING FROM THE SMALL SIDEWALKS WHICH WEREN'T MUCH WIDER THAN THE STREET. THERE WERE OLD FRENCH WOMEN WITH ^{IR} ~~THERE~~ SHOPPING BAGS ON THEIR ARMS, YOUNG CHILDREN, CLOMPING ALONG NOISELY IN THEIR WOODEN SOLED SHOES, STICKS OF THE LONG LOAVES OF FRENCH BREAD IN THEIR ARMS LIKE ~~THE~~ BUNDLES OF WOOD. THERE WERE STUDENTS OF THE BEAUX ARTS, COMING OUT OF SHOPS TALKING TO ONE ANOTHER EXCITEDLY, AND WAVING THEIR ARMS AS ONLY THE FRENCH CAN, WHEN THEY TALK WITH ONE ANOTHER.

EACH ONE HAD A BRIEF CASE OR A DRAWING PORTFOLIO UNDER ^{HIS} ~~THEIR~~ ARMS, OR PERHAPS A STRETCHED CANVAS ON A FRAME. THE BOYS ALL SEEMED TO HAVE BEARDS AND THEIR CLOTHING SIMPLY SPOKE THE WORDS, "STUDENT ". WHY IS IT THAT THE WORLD OVER, ALL STUDENTS SEEM TO LOOK ALIKE? PERHAPS IT IS THEIR DRESS AND THEIR MANNER, BUT IT IS EASY TO DISTINGUISH IN A CROWD OF PERSONS ON THE STREET, THOSE ~~WHO ARE MOST LIKELY~~ WHO ARE MOST LIKELY STUDENTS.

, WE DODGED THROUGH THE CROWD AND MOVED ON DOWN THE STREET TOWARDS THE SEINE. ABOUT A BLOCK FROM THE RIVER WE CAME TO THE BIG IRON GATES OF THE SCHOOL. IT WAS SET BACK IN A LARGE, COBBLESTOENED COURT. THE COURT WAS

The building was ~~very~~ old and ^{the stone of} its exterior surface was blackened with age. It seemed a maze of courts, doors, porticos, columns, and statue lined hallways.

FULL OF GREEK AND ROMAN STATUARY, PARTS OF RUINED BUILDINGS, IRON GRILL WORKS. IT WAS IN FACT A SMALL MUSEUM IN ITSELF. - *describe buildings appearance*

WE WALKED IN THROUGH THE GATES AND, AFTER ASKING IN OUR VERY BAD FRENCH, FOR DIRECTIONS, FOUND OUR WAY TO THE PROPER ATELIER OR CLASSROOM ~~AS WE CALL~~ ~~THEM IN THE STATES~~. MOST OF THE OTHER ^{SOLDIER -} ~~AMERICAN~~ ^{ALREADY} STUDENTS WERE THERE, AND AFTER TAKING A CHAIR WE WAITED FOR IT ALL TO BEGIN.

WE DIDN'T HAVE LONG TO WAIT. THE DIRECTOR OF THE SCHOOL WALKED INTO THE ROOM FOLLOWED BY AN ENTOURAGE OF THREE OR FOUR BUSTLING LITTLE MEN. ^{WHO SEEMED TO LOOK UPON HIM AS GOD.} HE WAS IMMACUATELY DRESSED IN A LIGHT GRAY SUIT, WHITE SHIRT, ^{maroon tie} SHINY BLACK SHOES AND GREY SPATS. HE WAS A TALL, STATELY LOOKING OLD BOY WITH HAIR AND A MUSTACHE AS WHITE AS HIS SHIRT AND HE SMILED AT US ~~WINNINGLY~~ AS HE WALKED TO ^A ~~THE~~ DESK IN THE FRONT OF THE ROOM.

"Bon jour, monsieurs, " AND HE BEGAN A LITTLE SPEECH IN FRENCH. ~~AT THAT TIME, MY KNOWLEDGE OF FRENCH WAS VERY SKETCHY AND I COULDN'T UNDERSTAND VERY MUCH OF WHAT HE SAID.~~ ^{WHICH I didn't understand at all} ^{although} IT WAS SOMETHING ABOUT WELCOMING US TO THE SCHOOL, AND HE HOPED WE WOULD BE HAPPY HERE, ETC. ETC. AFTER HIS TALK WE LEFT THE ROOM AND WENT TO OUR VARIOUS ATELIERS TO MEET OUR "maitres".

THERE WERE SIX MEN IN THE GROUP I WAS ASSIGNED TO. WE WALKED UP A WINDING STAIRCASE AND DOWN A HALLWAY, FOLLOWING ONE OF THE FRENCH STUDENTS WHO HAD BEEN SENT TO ACT AS OUR GUIDE. WE ENTERED A LONG, HIGH CEILINGED ROOM WHICH WAS FULL OF DRAFTING BOARDS AND TABLES, ^{students busily} A STUDENT CROUCHED OVER ^{them, busily} EACH ONE.

IT WOULD BE IMPOSSIBLE TO DESCRIBE THE ~~NOISE AND BEDLAM~~ ^{design problem due the next day.} THAT WAS TAKING PLACE IN THE ROOM. THERE WAS A ~~CHAIR~~ ^A ~~ON~~ AND THEY WERE WORKING FEVERISHLY. THEY WERE SHOUTING, SINGING, THROWING PAPER LEFT AND RIGHT, DRYING STRETCHES BY HOLDING THEM NEAR PILES OF BURNING TRACING PAPER, AND ELSEWHERE IN THE

ROOM, OTHER STUDENTS WERE RENDERING MADLY AT THEIR DRAWINGS.

OUR PRESENCE WAS NOTICED IMMEDIATELY AND THE AIR WAS FILLED WITH SHOUTS OF "neuveaux.....neuveaux..." THAT WAS WHAT THEY CALLED THEIR NEW STUDENTS, THE FIRST YEAR MEN. WE WERE NATURALLY A LITTLE EMBARRASSED BY IT ALL, BUT WE GRINNED BRAVELY AND STOOD OUR GROUND.

A TALL, HEAVILY SET FELLOW APPROACHED US. HE HAD AN AIR OF AUTHORITY ABOUT HIM AND THE NOISE SEEMED TO DIE DOWN SOMEWHAT AS HE BEGAN TO SPEAK TO US IN HALTING ENGLISH.

" I am le massier. " AND HE TOLD US HIS NAME AND BEGAN TO SHAKE HANDS WITH EACH ONE OF US. MASSIER WAS THE NAME GIVEN TO THE HEAD STUDENT OF EACH ATELIER. HE WAS ALWAYS ONE OF THE LAST YEAR MEN AND HIS WORD WAS LAW IN THE CLASS. HE ACTED AS THE PROFESSOR TO THE CLASS WHEN THE maitre WAS NOT THERE.

THE MASTER LED US AROUND THE CLASS ROOM, EXPLAINING TO US THAT THE STUDENTS WERE "en charet ". WE LOOKED AT SOME OF THE DRAWINGS THEY WERE WORKING OVER. THE PROJET WAS A MOSQUE. ALL THE NEUVEAUX WERE WORKING ON CHINESE INK WASH RENDERINGS OF ~~KKKKK~~ CORINTHIAN COLUMNS. THE ROOM WAS A MESS. THE FLOORS WERE COVERED ALMOST ANKLE DEEP WITH TRACING PAPER, CHARRED ^{IE} PEICES OF PAPER AND WOOD. ALL THE DESKS WERE ^{AND} ~~COVERED~~ ^{PILED UP} WITH PAINT POTS, BRUSHES, PENCILS, SKETCHES. THERE WERE AS MANY AS THREE AND FOUR MEN WORKING AS 2 "negres" ~~KKKKKKKKKKK~~ ON SOME OF THE RENDERINGS.

ALL THE NOISE IN THE ROOM STOPPED AS IF IT HAD BEEN TURNED OFF BY A SWITCH. WE LOOKED UP TO SEE ^{IF GENERAL DEGAULLE HAD WALKED IN} ~~WHAT THE REASON WAS. THE REASON WAS~~ THE "MAITRE" OR PROFESSOR. AS HE ENTERED THE ROOM, IT WAS IMMEDIATELY QUIET. NOT A SOUND FROM ANY ONE AND ALL EYES WERE ON HIM AS HE WALKED TOWARDS OUR LITTLE GROUP.

PROFFESSEUR LECONTE WAS A SHORT LITTLE MAN WITH A SAD FACE AND A BIG

THE SURROUNDINGS IN WHICH WE WORKED AT THE BEAUX ARTS WERE MUCH DIFFERENT COMPARED TO WHAT WE HAD BEEN ACCUSTOMED TO IN OUR VARIOUS UNIVERSITIES IN AMERICA. IN ALL ARCHITECTURAL LABS , THERE IS ALWAYS A CERTAIN AMOUNT OF HORSEPLAY AND NOISE BUT IT WAS NOTHING COMPARED TO WHAT TOOK PLACE IN THE ATELIERS AT THE BEAUX ARTS. THERE WAS A SAYING THERE ABOUT BEAUX ART STUDENTS. THEY WERE ALL SUPPOSED TO BE CRAZY; SCULPTORS, PAINTERS, AND ARCHITECTS. BUT OF THE THREE GROUPS, THE ARCHITECTS HAD THE REPUTATION OF BEING THE CRAZIEST. ~~THEY XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX~~ ~~GOING TO WORK IN THE ATELIER, THEY WERE ALL~~ ~~THE ARCHITECTS~~ ^{BOYS IN} ~~THE ARCHITECTS~~ ^{MY ATELIER.} WENT TO GREAT LENGTHS TO MAINTAIN THIS HIGH HONOR.

THE ONLY TIME THE ATELIER WAS QUIET WAS WHEN THE MAITRE PAYED HIS VISIT TO OBSERVE THE WORK AND GIVE CRITIQUES. HE CAME TO THE LAB THREE DAYS A WEEK FOR ABOUT TWO HOURS. THE REST OF THE TIME, IT WAS EVERY MAN FOR HIMSELF AND GOD HELP THE POOR nouveaux. WE WERE ALLOWED TO WORK AS ~~ELIXIR~~ ~~XXXXXXXXXXXX~~ "Vielle elevés" OR OLD STUDENTS AND SO WERE NOT SUBJECT TO THE PUNISHMENT AND HAZING THAT THE NEW STUDENTS WERE PUT THROUGH.

WHEN AN OLD STUDENT WANTED SOME MENIAL TASK PERFORMED, SUCH AS ~~A~~ PENCIL SHARPENED OR, PERHAPS NEEDED TO GO OUT TO ONE OF THE SHOPS TO PURCHASE A SHEET OF DRAWING PAPER, HE SIMPLY SHOUTED AT THE TOP OF HIS VOICE, " *serviceee* ! "

" Service ". and it WAS THE DUTY OF A NEUVEAUX TO COME RUNNING TO DO HIS BIDDING. IF IT WAS NECESSARY FOR HIM TO CALL FOR SERVICE MORE THAN TWICE, THERE WERE ALL SORTS OF INTERESTING PUNISHMENTS FOR THE GUILTY.

ONE OF THE MOST USUAL WAS FOR THE NEUVEAU TO LOOSE A LOCK OF HAIR. THEY KEPT A HUGE PAIR OF TIN SNIPS HANGING ON THE WALL FOR THIS PURPOSE. SOME OF THE MORE SLOW-MOVING MEN WERE ALMOST BALD FROM THEIR INTERMITTENT HAIR CUTS. ANOTHER PENALTY WAS HANGING BY THE KNEES FROM AN IRON PIPE WHICH

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RAN THE LENGTH OF THE ATELIER. THE NEUVEAUX USUALLY WERE REQUIRED TO
REMOVE THEIR CLOTHING FOR THIS ~~RIGHT~~ ^{RITE} AND SOMETIMES THERE WOULD BE AS
MANY AS TEN OR TWELVE OF THEM, SUSPENDED UPSIDE DOWN FROM THE PIPE, ~~AND~~
~~XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX~~ LOOKING FOR ALL THW WOERD LIKE A BUNCH OF
DRESSED CHICKENS HANGING IN A BUTCHER SHOP WINDOW.

WHILE THEY WERE IN THIS HELPLESS POSITION, THE OLD STUDENTS WOULD GRAB
A BRUSH AND A TUBE OF WATER COLOR OR BOTTLE OF COLORED INK AND GO DOWN THE
LINE PAINTING DESIGNS ON FACES, CHESTS , AROUND ~~TM~~ NAVELS AND MORE
INTIMATE PARTS. AFTER THIS THEY WOULD ALL STEP BACK AND ADMIRE AND COMMENT
^{EACH OTHERS}
ON ~~THE~~ WORK IN FLOWERY FRENCH PHRASES. YOU WOULD THINK THEY WERE IN AN ART
^{LATEST}
GALLERY LOOKING AT THE WORKS OF MATISSE OR PICASO.

SOAP WAS HARD TO GET IN PARIS THEN AND SOME OF THE NEUVEAUX WORE THEIR
^{FOR DAYS.}
DESIGNS ~~LIKE TATOC MARKS.~~

ON THE DOOR OF THE ROOM IN WHICH I WORKED, THERE WAS A HUGE SIGN WHICH
ONE OF THE OLD MEN HAD PAINTED. IT READ,

" ALL NEAUVEAUX
WHO ENTER THIS ROOM WILL DO SO
WITH THEIR TROUSERS
CARRIED ON THEIR
ARM."

~~XXX~~ THEY DID.

THE WALLS OF THE ATELIER WERE COVERED WITH MOTTOS AND VARIOUS TYPES
OF PAINTING AND CARTOONING DONE BY THE STUDENTS OF ~~PRKE~~ THIS AND PRECEEDING
YEARS. SOME OF IT WAS THE TYPE OF THING ONE FINDS WRITTEN ON THE WALLS OF
^{TOILETS}
~~THE OUT HOUSE~~ BUT MOST OF IT WAS OF A MORE HIGHER PLANE.

ON THE END WALL WAS A LARGE, SHAPELY, AND COMPLETELY NUDE VENUS ~~TYPE~~
~~WOMAN~~. SHE WAS PAINTEDD A BRIGHT YELLOW COLOR AND APPEARED TO BE FLYING
^{BEING}
~~ALONG~~ ABOVE THE GLASS, HER WINGS ~~WERE~~ TWO VERY LONG AND OVERSIZED BREASTS,

~~XXXXXXXXXXXX~~ OUTSTRETCHED LIKE THE WINGS OF A FLYING FORTRESS.
THE NIPPLE OF THE ONE ON THE STARBOARD SIDE WAS PAINTED RED AND THE ONE
TO PORT, GREEN. OR WAS IT VICE VERSA. I DON'T REMEMBER.

IN
THERE WAS A MOTTO INSCRIBED ~~ON~~ ANOTHER PLACE WHICH EXPRESSED THE SENT-
IMENT OF SOME STUDENT IN THE DISTANT PAST. IT WAS WRITTEN IN ELABORATE
SCRIPT AND IT PROCLAIMED FOR ALL TO SEE,

" STUDYING AT THE ECOLE DES BEAUX ARTS IS LIKE MAKING LOVE WITH A PROPHLAXIS!"

(THIS IS A ROUGH TRANSLATION FROM THE ORIGINAL FRENCH.)

THE REST OF THE WALLS WERE COVERED WITH DIFFERENT THINGS, NAMES OF THE
CLASSES OF EACH YEAR, (THERE WAS A CONSPICUOUS BLANK DURING THE WAR YEARS,)
MEN WHO WERE PRISONERS OF WAR AND THE POLITICAL DEPORTEES, WINNERS OF THE
"GRANDE PRIX ".

BUT MY FAVORITE OF THEM ALL WAS THE ~~XXXXXX~~ FLYING, YELLOW VENUS.

EVERY MORNING WHEN I ENTERED THE ATELIER, I EXPECTED ANYTHING AND USUALLY
~~FOUND~~ GOT IT. ONE SIMPLY HAD TO ADOPT THE ATTITUDE TO NOT BE SUPRISED AT WHAT-
EVER WENT ON. THERE MIGHT BE A MIGHTY CHORUS OF VOICES SINGING THE SONG
OF THE BEAUX ARTS WITH ONE OF THE OLD MEN IN FRONT OF THE CLASS, STANDING
ON A DESK, DIRECTING WITH A T-SQUARE.

OR YOU MIGHT ENCOUNTER A MAN EN CHARET STANDIND BACK FROM HIS DRAWING,
SLINGING PAINT AT IT LIKE A MAD MAN, POURING WATER ON IT AND EVERY THING
ELSE. SOME INTERESTING EFFECTS WERE OBTAINED THIS WAY. THE CLASSIC EXAMPLE
WAS THAT OF ONE OF THE BOYS WHO CAME TO THE ATELIER ONE DAY, SLIGHTLY TIGHT.
HE HAD BEEN WORKING HARD ON HIS ~~RENDERING~~ ^{PROBLEM} AND HE HAD A GOOD DESIGN BUT HE
JUST COULDNT SEEM TO GET THE RIGHT EFFECT , IN HIS RENDERING. NO ONE PAID TOO
MUCH ATTENTION TO HIM UNTIL HE CLIMBED UP ON TOP OF HIS DESK AND BEGAN TO
URINATE ON HIS DRAWING. THE FRENCH STUDENTS RUSHED TO HIM, PULLED HIM DOWN
AND SOME OF THEM GRABBED THE ~~NEW~~ BOARD A BEGAN TO SPONGE THE URINE OFF OF ^{from}
IT IN AN ~~ANY~~ EFFORT TO SAVE THE DRAWING WHICH WAS DUE THE NEXT MORNING.

THE TOUCH OF URINE DID IT. THE DESIGN, ~~XXXXXXXXXXXX~~ WHICH INCIDENTALLY
WAS FOR A "VILLA BY THE SEA", WAS SUBMITTED AND IT TOOK SECOND MEDAL!

YOU CAN'T BEAT THE FRENCH FOR ORIGINALITY.

When I think of Paris now, a few months after leaving it, I look back with regret on the many places I did not see and the things I had intended to do but just never seemed to get around to doing.

The Paris I knew and the Paris that I shall see in my mind's eye when I think of the city will not be the elegant, style center, the city of light. The Paris I knew was ~~the Paris~~ immediately after the ending of the war. The city struggling to drag herself from the depths to which the war and the subsequent occupation by the Germans had plunged her.

But Paris is ~~always~~ Paris. There shall always be, I think, that same spirit coursing through the city's veins which makes her as she is.

The artist, the poet, the rich traveller or the tourist, the people who have seen her in her highest glory and in her lowest disgrace. All can ^{FEEL} ~~always sense~~ in her, the ~~same~~ ^{MEANS} spirit that is Paris.

The bum who used to sleep on the ~~ventilating~~ warm gratings of the Metro ventilation grills ~~on the sidewalks on the Boulevard des Italiens,~~ ^{OR} he knows the same as the gendarme at the Place de L'Opera, the "types" in the cafes, the "poule" along the Champs Ellysesses, the workers in the fabriques in BILLAN COURT, the street sweepers, the vendors, the students ~~in~~ along the Boulevard St Michel, they all know and feel this spirit that means Paris, perhaps they are ~~in fact~~, part of the ^{INGREDIENT} ~~thing~~ which makes this spirit... ~~they know and anyone who has lived in Paris and learned to like the city...~~ ^{everyone who has learned to like the city,} has caught a spark of this thing of which I write.

Paris is always Paris. True the city which I knew was trying to recover from the war but I think I sensed the same ^{FEELING} ~~vitality~~ ^I which would have ~~been~~ ^{HAD I BEEN THERE YEARS BEFORE, OR AFTER THIS TIME.} felt ~~by someone before the war.~~

When I hear of Paris these are the things which I will see and hear.....

The long lines of Parisian housewives at the patisseries and boulangerie, waiting for their meager rations of bread or sausage.....

the crowded Metros, overflowing with American soldiers, trying to find their way about the city underground.... I can hear now, their shouts on the Place De Concorde late at night. Loading onto the trucks which have brought them into Paris for one days fun, now taking them back, out into the small villages or tent camps from which they came. Drunken oaths, singing, the smell of the cheap ice cream which the vendors sold.....

The lines of fiacras waiting along Avenue Wagram, steam rising from the flanks of their blanket draped horses.

The odor of the roasted horse chesnuts being carried along by the cold fall night air. And the hoarse voices of the vendors.

" Maroons chaud. Demandez maroons chaud."

The Arc de Triomphe, solemn, and grey, standing astride the Champs Elleysess like a silent sentry at the tomb of the unknown soldier.

The people sitting at the sidewalk cafes, quietly sipping their aperetifs, or perhaps not so quietly discussing politics over their ^{cafe} ~~imitation coffee~~.

The black dressed widows still sit on the benches in the parks or along the banks of the Seine, and walk quietly and obtrusively through the crowds as ~~always~~ in years past.

The children still sail their boats in the Fountain of the Jardins ~~at~~

de Luxembourg.....

The Latin Quarter with all its innumerable boites, cabarets, night clubs, cafes, students hotels, and narrow crowded streets. This is the old section of the city. Parts of buildings constructed by the

inconspicuously amidst the bustling busy boulevard and
Romans still stand ~~along one of the principle streets.....~~
the activities of the "Quartier Latin"

the white alabaster-like domes of the Sacre Coeur ^{rise} ~~rising~~ above the gay and gaudy district of Montmartre.....

The Deux Maggots, The Dome, The Metropole, The Quatz Arts, Le Tango Chat,

Pam Pam, Cafe de la Paix, The Ascot Bar, Harry's New York Bar (just ask for sank roo do noo) the Bal Tabarin, the famous Follies Begere,

Casino de Paris, the ABC, Alhambra, *all the bright spots of amusement for which make "Paris" the gay city.*

— and above all I think of the ever-present American soldier. ~~I think of~~
~~any section of Paris which one could choose at a given time, there would~~
~~carnival appearing streets land that is Pigalle.~~
~~have been American soldiers. They covered the city like a blanket. One~~
~~along the grand boulevards and rues, in the~~
~~could hardly ever become lost on the streets. All you did was wait a few~~
~~cafes, on the metro, in every nook and cranny.~~
~~minutes and sure enough an American soldier would come along. If he didn't~~
~~you could not escape them. It was a G.I. Paris~~
~~know where you were, there would soon be one along who did,~~
in every sense.